GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

EXPENSES POLICY

Document Information	
Policy Name	Expenses Policy
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Financial Controls Policy, Conflict of Interest Policy, Volunteer Management Policy

1. Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation that relies entirely on volunteers, including trustees, to carry out its work. The Charity recognises that trustees and volunteers may incur out-of-pocket expenses when undertaking activities on behalf of the Charity and is committed to reimbursing legitimate expenses.

This policy sets out what expenses can be claimed, the limits that apply, and the procedures for claiming and approving expenses. It ensures that charitable funds are used appropriately and that trustees and volunteers are not financially disadvantaged by their voluntary service.

The Charity Commission guidance (CC11) confirms that charities may reimburse trustees for expenses properly incurred in carrying out their duties. This policy is consistent with that guidance.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Enable trustees and volunteers to be reimbursed for reasonable out-of-pocket expenses incurred while carrying out Charity activities
- Ensure proper stewardship of charitable funds
- Set clear limits and procedures for expenses claims
- Prevent trustees and volunteers from being financially disadvantaged
- Comply with Charity Commission guidance and HMRC requirements
- Maintain transparency and accountability

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All trustees of the Charity
- All volunteers carrying out activities on behalf of the Charity

This policy does not cover payments for goods or services provided to the Charity (which would be subject to procurement procedures) or any payments to trustees beyond reimbursement of expenses (which would require specific authorisation in accordance with Charity Commission guidance).

4. Key Principles

4.1 Eligible Expenses

The Charity will only reimburse expenses that are reasonable and necessarily incurred in carrying out Charity work. Expenses must be directly related to Charity activities and represent genuine out-of-pocket costs.

4.2 Segregation of Duties

To maintain proper financial controls, no person may:

- Both authorise and pay an expenses claim
- Authorise their own expenses claim
- Authorise expenses claims from family members or persons with whom they have a close personal relationship

4.3 Economy

Trustees and volunteers should choose the most economical option that is reasonable in the circumstances. Charitable funds must be used wisely, and excessive or unnecessary expenditure will not be reimbursed.

4.4 Receipts

All claims must be supported by receipts or other documentary evidence. Claims without receipts will only be reimbursed in exceptional circumstances where it was not reasonably possible to obtain a receipt, and a clear explanation is provided.

5. Eligible Expenses

Trustees and volunteers may claim for the following types of expenses when incurred in connection with Charity activities:

- Travel to and from trustee meetings
- Travel for Charity activities (e.g., visiting beneficiaries, meeting partner organisations, attending fundraising events, collecting donations from mosques)
- Subsistence (meals) when away from home for extended periods on Charity business
- Postage and stationery for Charity correspondence
- Telephone calls made for Charity business
- Overnight accommodation when necessary (with prior approval)
- Care costs for dependants while attending Charity meetings or events (with prior approval)

6. Travel Expenses

6.1 General Principle

Trustees and volunteers should travel by the most cost-effective means, taking into account the journey time, nature of the journey, and cost. The Charity encourages the use of public transport where practical.

6.2 Private Vehicle

Trustees and volunteers may use their own vehicle for Charity travel provided that:

- They hold a current, valid driving licence
- The vehicle has a valid MOT certificate (where applicable)
- The vehicle is insured for the intended use (business use may be required – claimants should check with their insurer)

Mileage will be reimbursed at HMRC approved rates:

Vehicle Type	Rate per Mile
Car/Van (first 10,000 miles)	45p
Car/Van (over 10,000 miles)	25p
Motorcycle	24p
Bicycle	20p
Passenger supplement (per passenger per mile)	5p

Note: These rates are subject to change if HMRC rates are updated. The Charity will apply the current HMRC approved mileage rates.

Parking charges and congestion charges necessarily incurred will be reimbursed with receipts. The Charity will not reimburse parking fines, speeding fines, or other penalties.

6.3 Public Transport

Bus and train fares will be reimbursed at standard class rates. Advance booking to obtain cheaper fares is encouraged where the journey is planned in advance. Receipts or tickets should be retained.

6.4 Taxis

Public transport should normally be used. However, taxis may be used and reimbursed where:

- Public transport is not available or practical
- Heavy or bulky items need to be transported
- The individual has mobility difficulties
- Late night travel (after 9pm) where safety would otherwise be a concern
- A taxi would be cheaper than the alternative
- In an emergency

7. Subsistence

Where a trustee or volunteer is away from home for an extended period on Charity business and needs to purchase food or refreshments, reasonable subsistence may be claimed.

Subsistence claims are subject to the following maximum limits:

Meal	Maximum Amount
Breakfast (if leaving home before 6am)	£7.00
Lunch (if away for 5 hours or more)	£7.00
Evening meal (if staying overnight or unable to return home before 9pm)	£7.00

Subsistence cannot be claimed if food is provided at the meeting, event, or accommodation. Alcohol cannot be claimed as a Charity expense.

8. Accommodation

Overnight accommodation may be booked where it is reasonable and cost-effective to stay away from home – for example, where an event finishes late and returning home the same day would be impractical. Overnight stays require prior approval from the Chair (or another trustee if the Chair is claiming).

A maximum of £25 may be claimed for staying overnight with friends or relatives (to cover their costs), with a receipt or written confirmation not required. Hotel or B&B accommodation should be modest and reasonable – typically a budget hotel. Hotel bookings require prior approval.

9. Other Expenses

9.1 Postage and Stationery

Postage costs and stationery purchased for Charity correspondence or activities may be claimed with receipts.

9.2 Telephone and Internet

The cost of telephone calls made specifically for Charity business may be claimed. Where calls are made from a personal mobile phone, an itemised bill showing the relevant calls should be provided. Small claims for occasional calls may be estimated where obtaining itemised records is impractical.

9.3 Care Costs

Trustees and volunteers may claim reasonable costs for childcare or care of other dependants incurred while attending Charity meetings or events. This recognises that caring responsibilities should not be a barrier to volunteering. Such claims require prior approval and receipts.

9.4 Shared Expenses

Where expenses are paid for a group (e.g., refreshments for several volunteers), one person should pay and submit the claim, noting the names of all individuals included.

10. Expenses Not Covered

The following expenses will not be reimbursed:

- Alcohol
- Fines and penalties (parking fines, speeding fines, etc.)
- Personal items
- Gifts
- Entertainment expenses
- First class travel (unless for medical reasons with prior approval)
- Expenses incurred by family members or others not volunteering for the Charity
- Any expenses without prior approval where such approval is required by this policy

11. Claims Procedure

11.1 Submitting Claims

Expenses claims should be submitted using the Charity's Expenses Claim Form (see Appendix 1). Claims should:

- Be submitted promptly, and in any event within three months of the expense being incurred
- Include all original receipts (or copies where originals are not available)
- Clearly state the purpose of each expense and how it relates to Charity activities
- For mileage claims, state the start point, end point, and reason for the journey
- Be signed and dated by the claimant

11.2 Approval

Expenses claims should be submitted to the Chair of Trustees for approval. Claims from the Chair should be submitted to another trustee. The approver should check that claims comply

with this policy, are supported by receipts, and represent reasonable and necessary expenditure.

11.3 Checking Claims

The approving trustee should verify that:

- The expenses were incurred in carrying out legitimate Charity activities
- The amounts claimed are reasonable
- Receipts are provided
- The claim complies with the limits in this policy
- Any prior approvals required were obtained

11.4 Payment

Approved expenses will be reimbursed by bank transfer. Expenses should be paid within 14 days of approval. The person making the payment must not be the same person who approved the claim.

12. Record Keeping

The Charity will retain records of all expenses claims, including:

- Completed claim forms
- Supporting receipts
- Approval records
- Payment records

Records will be retained for six years in accordance with the Charity's records retention policy. Trustee expenses may need to be disclosed in the Charity's annual accounts.

13. Minimising Costs

Trustees and volunteers should be mindful that every pound spent on expenses is a pound that cannot be used to help beneficiaries. While the Charity is committed to reimbursing legitimate expenses, everyone is encouraged to:

- Consider whether travel is necessary, or whether the same outcome could be achieved by telephone or video call
- Share travel where multiple people are attending the same event
- Book travel in advance to obtain cheaper fares
- Choose cost-effective options
- Consider whether they wish to waive any or all of their expenses claim as a donation to the Charity (though the Charity does not expect or require this)

14. Concerns and Disputes

If a claimant disagrees with a decision to reject or reduce an expenses claim, they may request a review by the Board of Trustees. The Board's decision will be final.

Any concerns about inappropriate expenses claims or potential abuse of this policy should be reported to the Chair of Trustees (or to another trustee if the concern relates to the Chair).

15. Review

This policy will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees every two years, or sooner if:

- HMRC mileage or subsistence rates change
- Charity Commission guidance changes
- Issues arise with the current policy
- The Board identifies a need for updates

16. Related Policies and Guidance

Related Charity Policies:

- Financial Controls Policy
- Conflict of Interest Policy
- Volunteer Management Policy

External Guidance:

- Charity Commission – Trustee expenses and payments (CC11)
- HMRC – Expenses and benefits: travel and subsistence
- HMRC – Travel: mileage and fuel rates and allowances

17. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

18. Trustee Declaration

We, the undersigned trustees of Gloucester Zakat Charity, confirm that we have read, understood, and approved this Expenses Policy and commit to its implementation.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

Appendix 1: Expenses Claim Form

GLOUCESTER ZAKAT CHARITY

EXPENSES CLAIM FORM

Name:	
Role:	☐ Trustee ☐ Volunteer
Claim Period:	From: _____ To: _____

EXPENSES DETAILS

Date	Description / Purpose	Type	Receipt?	Amount
			☐ Yes ☐ No	£
			☐ Yes ☐ No	£
			☐ Yes ☐ No	£
			☐ Yes ☐ No	£
			☐ Yes ☐ No	£
			☐ Yes ☐ No	£
			TOTAL CLAIMED:	**£**

MILEAGE CLAIMS (if applicable):

Date	From	To	Miles	Amount
				£
				£
				£
			MILEAGE TOTAL:	**£**

DECLARATIONS AND SIGNATURES

Claimant Declaration:	**Approved by:**
I confirm that these expenses were incurred wholly and necessarily in connection with Charity activities and that the information provided is accurate. Signature: _____ Date: _____	I confirm that I have checked this claim and it complies with the Expenses Policy. Name: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____

Bank details for payment:
Account Name: _____ Sort Code: _____ Account No: _____

For Office Use:

Payment made by: _____ *Date:* _____ *Reference:* _____

--- End of Policy ---